

2ai	The gravitational potential at a point is the <u>work done per unit mass</u> (by an external force) in bringing a <u>small test mass</u> from infinity to that point.
2aii	gravitational potential at O = gravitational potential due to M at O + gravitational potential due to N at O $= -\frac{GM}{0.5d} + \left(-\frac{GM}{0.5d}\right)$ where d is the distance between the centres of the stars $= -\frac{4GM}{d}$ $= -\frac{4(6.67 \times 10^{-11})(3.5 \times 10^{30})}{2.0 \times 10^{11}}$ $= -4.67 \times 10^9 \text{ J kg}^{-1}$

2aiii For the asteroid to escape from the stars, it needs to reach infinity with min k.e.

By principle of conservation of energy,

EITHER

total energy of asteroid at O = total energy of asteroid at infinity

$$m_{\text{asteroid}}\phi + \frac{1}{2}m_{\text{asteroid}}v_{\text{min}}^2 = 0 + 0$$

$$\frac{1}{2}m_{\text{asteroid}}v_{\text{min}}^2 = \frac{4GM}{d}m_{\text{asteroid}}$$

$$v_{\text{min}} = \sqrt{\frac{8GM}{d}}$$

$$= \sqrt{\frac{8(6.67 \times 10^{-11})(3.5 \times 10^{30})}{2.0 \times 10^{11}}}$$

$$= 9.7 \times 10^4 \text{ m s}^{-1}$$

OR

loss in KE of the asteroid = gain in GPE of the asteroid

$$\frac{1}{2}m_{\text{asteroid}}v_{\text{min}}^2 - 0 = 0 - m_{\text{asteroid}}\phi$$

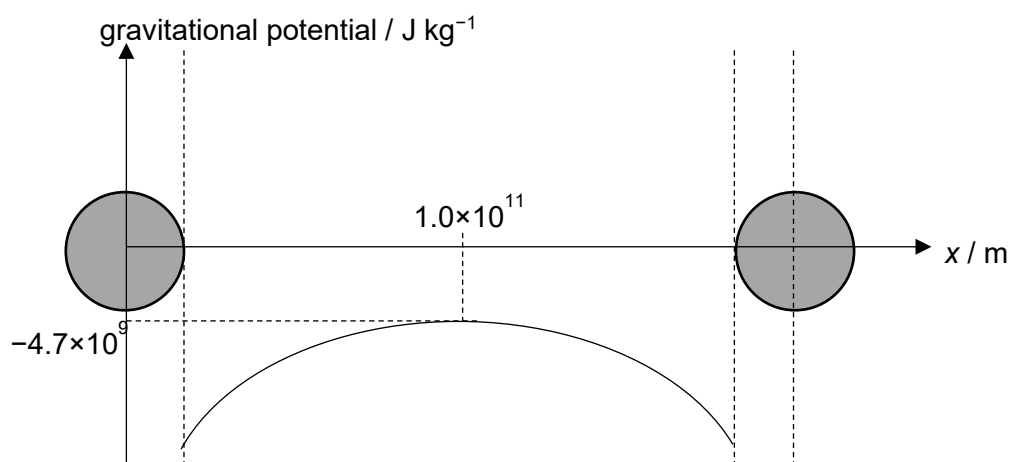
$$\frac{1}{2}m_{\text{asteroid}}v_{\text{min}}^2 = \frac{4GM}{d}m_{\text{asteroid}}$$

$$v_{\text{min}} = \sqrt{\frac{8GM}{d}}$$

$$= \sqrt{\frac{8(6.67 \times 10^{-11})(3.5 \times 10^{30})}{2.0 \times 10^{11}}}$$

$$= 9.7 \times 10^4 \text{ m s}^{-1}$$

2aiv Inverted U shape below horizontal axis
Symmetrical



2bi	The gravitational force is <u>just sufficient</u> to provide the centripetal force OR The acceleration/force and velocity of the stars are <u>constantly/always</u> perpendicular to each other
2bii	The gravitational force on the star provides the centripetal force $\frac{GMM}{d^2} = M\left(\frac{d}{2}\right)\omega^2$ $\omega = \sqrt{\frac{2GM}{d^3}}$ $= \sqrt{\frac{2(6.67 \times 10^{-11})(3.5 \times 10^{30})}{(2.0 \times 10^{11})^3}}$ $= 2.416 \times 10^{-7} \text{ rad s}^{-1}$ $T = \frac{2\pi}{\omega}$ $= \frac{2\pi}{2.416 \times 10^{-7}}$ $= 2.601 \times 10^7 \text{ s}$ $= 0.82 \text{ years}$

3a	the increase in internal energy of a system is equal to the sum of the heat supplied to the
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